Zach Shallbetter
2224 W Bruce Ave., Spokane, WA 99208
zachshallbetter@gmail.com | (509) 201-7432
medium.com/zachshallbetter | linkedin.com/in/zachshallbetter | github.com/zachshallbetter

Summary

Trained in growth strategy by the SBA, with extensive mentorship and proven results across agencies, SaaS, government, gaming, e-commerce, and fintech, my career spans corporate and startup environments. I've had the privilege of collaborating with industry leaders like Amazon, Intel, American Airlines, Nike, and the Gates Foundation, while also building and scaling my own ventures to deliver impactful products. As a Senior Product Manager, I excel in team building, aligning technical execution with strategic vision, and driving transformative outcomes.

What Sets Me Apart

I'm not your typical product leader—I'm an engineer, creator, and innovator with a hands-on, multidisciplinary background. I've orchestrated large-scale events, scaled digital studios, engineered and manufactured physical products, and exhibited my art in galleries. Whether in fast-paced startups or structured corporate settings, I thrive in scenarios where I can lead teams to overcome barriers, create benchmark-defining solutions, and deliver measurable results. My personal motivation lies in crafting human experiences that resonate deeply with people.

Key Skills and Expertise

1. **Technical and Product Leadership**
   Combining deep technical expertise with product strategy, I design scalable systems and lead seamless product lifecycles that align with business goals and user needs.

2. **Production, Marketing, and Customer-Centric Innovation**
   I manage every stage of production, execute marketing strategies that drive engagement, and create transformative experiences that foster customer loyalty and deliver measurable value.

3. **Data-Driven Decision Making**
   By analyzing data and market trends, I develop strategies that enhance platform performance, improve user engagement, and drive measurable business outcomes.

4. **Cross-Functional Team Alignment**
   I unite creative, technical, and business teams under a shared vision, fostering collaboration and delivering results that exceed expectations.

5. **AI-Enhanced Team Optimization**
   I integrate Generative AI tools to elevate team performance, streamline workflows, boost creativity, and tackle complex challenges in production, design, and development.

6. **Scalable System Architecture**
   I design modular, adaptable systems that support organizational growth while improving user experiences across diverse touchpoints.

7. **Creative Vision and Design Expertise**
   With a strong foundation in Graphic Design, UX/UI, Illustration, Invention, and Storytelling, I bring an innovative perspective to product development and problem-solving.

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Work Experience

Southwest Association for Indian Arts — Senior Manager, Digital Products
February 2023 – December 2024

- Defined, scoped, and executed a multi-year product vision for *The Indigenous Collections*, an AI-driven e-commerce platform showcasing Indigenous art, leveraging 100 years of curated data.
- Integrated generative AI and machine learning models to deliver personalized user experiences and intelligent search capabilities, boosting engagement and discoverability.
- Unified product, engineering, and UX teams under a cohesive roadmap, reducing development timelines from 2 years to 6 months.

North Idaho College — Assistant Professor - SA, Web & UX
June 2022 – June 2023

- Designed and implemented an industry-focused curriculum in web development and UX/UI design, achieving a 100% graduation rate and increasing tech industry job placements.
- Mentored adult students in web development and UX strategies, bridging foundational theory with real-world applications to prepare them for competitive roles.
- Collaborated with local tech organizations to establish internship pipelines, providing students with hands-on experience and stronger industry connections.

Cursed Crypt — Founder and Chief Product Officer (CPO)
May 2018 – September 2022

- Crowdfunded, built, and scaled a profitable gaming enterprise, exceeding Kickstarter goals by 330% and generating $1.2M in first-year revenue through custom-engineered magnetic game board technology.
- Developed an in-house, on-demand manufacturing process, reducing costs and enabling the production of 25,000 game boards and 2,000 miles of printed maps and materials.
- Executed an e-commerce strategy featuring just-in-time production, automated workflows, and seamless delivery, driving operational scalability.

Uxiliary — Co-Founder and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)
October 2014 – November 2020

- Founded and led a digital solutions agency delivering product strategy, development, and design for Fortune 500 clients (Nike, Intel, Dell), generating over $10M annually in client value.
- Worked directly with stakeholders to define project goals, create strategic roadmaps, and align technical execution with business objectives, ensuring measurable success.
- Directed cross-functional teams across design, engineering, and marketing to create transformative digital products, consistently exceeding key performance and engagement metrics (KPIs).

Inland Northwest Technology Alliance (NPO) — President and Chairman
January 2015 – January 2020

14Four — Frontend Developer
May 2012 – December 2013

OpenEye — Lead Web Developer
January 2007 – May 2012

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Education

- **Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering –** Western Governors University, Salt Lake City, UT
- **Associate of Science in Computer Science –** North Idaho College, Coeur d'Alene, ID

Certifications

- **Certified Postsecondary Educator –** Idaho Division of Career and Technical Education (IDCTE)
- **T.H.R.I.V.E. Executive Business Training –** Emerging Leaders Program (ELP), Washington SBA
- **AI for Product Management Certification –** Pendo
- **Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO) –** Scrum Alliance

Awards and Achievements

- **Mayoral Entrepreneurship Award:** Honored for impactful contributions to the community.
- **AADDY Award:** Recognized for excellence in innovative advertising campaigns.
- **Regional Leadership Award:** Recognized for driving innovation and growth in the Spokane region.

Technical Skills

- **Frontend and UI Development:** Proficient in React, Next.js, JavaScript, TypeScript, Tailwind, SCSS, HTML, and CSS, with expertise in accessible interaction and responsive, user-focused interfaces.
- **Backend Development and Infrastructure:** Experienced in Node.js, Python, Docker, PostgreSQL, Redis, and MongoDB. Deploying scalable systems like AWS, Vercel, Supabase, and Google Cloud Services.
- **Design and Collaboration Tools:** Fluent in Adobe Creative Suite, Figma, Sketch, Storybook, Design Tokens, enabling seamless collaboration between engineering, UX, and game design teams.
- **Advanced Technologies:** Hands-on experience with AI/ML tools (GPT, Llama, TensorFlow, LangChain) and cutting-edge frameworks to enhance interactivity and immersion.
- **Methodologies:** Deep expertise in Agile, Scrum, and Six Sigma, and Kaizen ensuring efficient, iterative development aligned with strategic goals.
- **Search and Social:** Skilled in integrating and optimizing search algorithms, recommendation systems, and social platform interactions to enhance engagement and discoverability.

Key Differentiators

- **Production Expertise:** Proficient in system architecture, product design, and scalable platforms, with proven ability to manage lifecycles, align goals, and ensure seamless experiences.
- **Data-Driven Insights:** I leverage data and market trends to inform strategic decisions, improve user engagement, and drive measurable growth.
- **Cross-Functional Leadership:** By uniting creative, technical, and business teams, I foster collaboration and alignment, driving impactful results across departments.
- **Adaptive Problem Solving**: I navigate complex challenges with ease, optimizing functionality, design, production, marketing, and budgets to deliver innovative solutions.
- **Design Leadership:** My extensive background in design, UX/UI, and illustration allows me to bring a creative edge to problem-solving and product development.
- **Team-Centric Leadership:** I specialize in aligning diverse teams toward shared goals, resolving conflicts, and creating a collaborative culture that drives exceptional outcomes.
- **Versatility:** Whether it's designing systems, interpreting data, or leading teams, I adapt to dynamic challenges and consistently deliver impactful solutions.

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